

46 Reported speech with negatives

Negatives in reported speech are formed in the same way as negatives in direct speech. "Not" is used with the auxiliary, or with the main verb if there is no auxiliary.

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46.1 REPORTING NEGATIVE AUXILIARIES

When the direct speech is negative using "do not," "is not," and "has not," "do," "is," or "has" changes tense, rather than the main verb.



I **don't** work on weekends.

Present simple negative.

He said he **didn't** work on weekends.

Past simple negative.



FURTHER EXAMPLES



I **don't** want to drive. I'd rather walk.

Sue said she **didn't** want to drive. She'd rather walk.



The car **isn't** starting.

They told me the car **wasn't** starting.



They **haven't** arrived on time because of the car.

Fay said they **hadn't** arrived on time because of the car.

